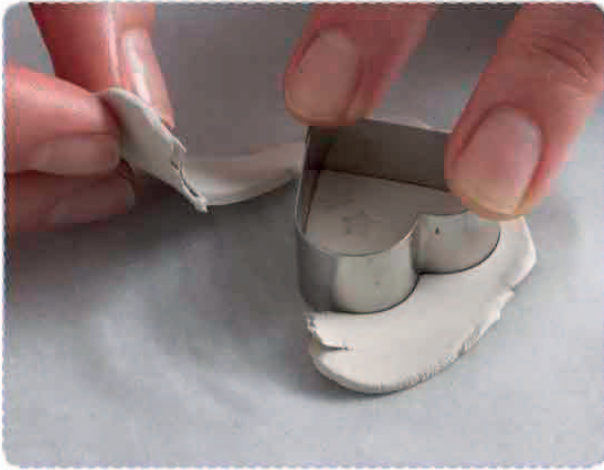




7 Cut the heart out by positioning the cutter over the indent made in step 4. Remove the excess clay from around the cutter. Roll up any scraps of clay and store them in clingfilm in an airtight container for future use. If the clay is starting to dry out, brush it lightly with water before storing.



8 Leave the clay to dry overnight or, to speed up the process, you can use a hair dryer or put the clay in an oven at 150°C (300°F/Gas 2) for 10 minutes. The clay must be completely dry before firing. Make sure it is dry by putting it on a mirror: if any condensation appears, it means there is still moisture in the clay.



9 Once the clay is dry it is extremely fragile, so be gentle. Sand the charm, starting with the 180 grit sanding pad. Next use the 220 grit sanding pad followed by the 280 grit one to achieve a smooth finish. Do not sand over the fingerprint. When you have finished, there should be no marks other than the fingerprint and the stars.

The more you work metal clay, the drier it becomes, so moisten it if any cracks appear.